



Gov Secure

Confident AI, Controlled Risk.

AI GOVERNANCE PLATFORM FOR SMBs

90-Day AI Governance Implementation Blueprint

A Step-by-Step Rollout Plan for SMBs

Phase 1
Days 1–30
Foundation & Discovery

Phase 2
Days 31–60
Build & Assess

Phase 3
Days 61–90
Operationalize & Sustain

Version 1.0 | April 2026 | Confidential – Internal Use Only

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Executive Summary

This 90-Day AI Governance Implementation Blueprint provides Govsecure clients with a structured, actionable roadmap for standing up a complete AI governance program from scratch. Designed specifically for small and mid-sized businesses (SMBs), it transforms the comprehensive Govsecure AI Governance Checklist Templates into a phased sequence of concrete activities, ownership assignments, and measurable milestones.

At the end of 90 days, your organization will have a live AI inventory, a documented policy framework, completed risk assessments for active AI systems, trained staff, and a repeatable operational rhythm for ongoing AI governance—all aligned to NIST AI RMF, ISO 42001, and emerging regulatory requirements.

What This Blueprint Delivers

AI Inventory & System Registry	Every AI tool, model, and vendor feature documented and risk-tiered.
AI Governance Policy Suite	Foundational policies covering use, risk, privacy, and vendor management.
Risk Assessments	Completed risk assessments for all Active/High-risk AI use cases.
Vendor Due Diligence Files	Documented assessments for all AI-enabled vendors and SaaS tools.
Human Oversight Controls	Reviewer roles, escalation paths, and override procedures in place.
Incident Response Playbook	AI-specific IR procedures tested and embedded in existing processes.
Training Program	Role-based AI literacy and governance training completed across key staff.
Monitoring Cadence	Recurring review schedule established with assigned owners.

Govsecure Tip: AI governance does not require a large team or a big budget. It requires clarity, consistency, and accountability. This blueprint is designed so that a single part-time program owner, with cross-functional support, can complete it on schedule.

How to Use This Blueprint

This blueprint is organized into three 30-day phases, each broken down by week. Every week includes a structured activity table referencing the specific Govsecure checklist template that drives the work. Use it alongside your Govsecure checklist files—not as a replacement for them.

Core Roles

Role	Description	Suggested Profile
AI Governance Lead (AGL)	Owns the program, drives the blueprint, reports to leadership.	GRC Manager / CISO / COO delegate
Business Unit Leads (BUL)	Submit use cases, confirm AI tools in their area, review risk tiers.	Department Heads / Team Leads
IT / Security	Provide technical context, conduct security reviews, manage integrations.	IT Manager / Security Analyst
Legal / Privacy	Review data handling, contracts, DPIA requirements.	General Counsel / Privacy Officer
Procurement / Vendor Mgmt	Identify AI-enabled vendor agreements, support due diligence.	Procurement / Finance Lead
Executive Sponsor	Approves policies, receives monthly status briefings.	CEO / COO / CTO

Checklist Reference Key

AIR	AI Inventory & System Registry Checklist	VDD	AI Third-Party / Vendor Due Diligence Checklist
SEC	AI Security Review Checklist	PRI	AI Privacy & DPIA Screening Checklist
MVT	AI Model Validation / Testing Checklist	MON	AI Monitoring & Revalidation Checklist
CMC	AI Change Management Checklist	HOE	AI Human Oversight & Escalation Checklist
IRP	AI Incident Response Checklist	TRN	AI Training & Role-Based Awareness Checklist
POL	AI Policy-to-Control Mapping Checklist	REG	AI Regulatory Change Impact Assessment Checklist

PHASE 1

Foundation & Discovery

Days 1 – 30

Phase 1 lays the bedrock of your AI governance program. You will establish the governance structure, discover every AI system in use (including shadow AI), assign risk tiers, and launch foundational policy work. Nothing in the program can be calibrated without knowing what AI you actually have—so the AI inventory is the single most critical output of this phase.

Phase 1 Objectives

- Stand up the AI Governance program with a named lead, executive sponsor, and cross-functional working group.
- Complete a comprehensive AI Inventory covering all AI tools, models, vendors, and use cases.
- Assign a risk tier (Low / Moderate / High / Critical) to every discovered AI use case.
- Initiate foundational AI policy drafts (Acceptable Use, Risk, Data Handling).
- Establish intake and submission processes for new AI use case requests.
- Complete initial vendor identification for all AI-enabled third-party tools.

Week 1

Focus: Program Launch & Governance Setup

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Appoint AI Governance Lead (AGL) and Executive Sponsor	Exec Sponsor	AIR §1	Day 3
Form AI Governance Working Group (cross-functional)	AGL	AIR §1	Day 5
Define program charter, scope, and 90-day success criteria	AGL	POL	Day 7
Set up program tracking system (Jira / SharePoint / GRC tool)	IT / AGL	AIR §7	Day 7
Schedule all Phase 1 recurring standups and checkpoints	AGL	—	Day 5
Brief Executive Sponsor on program timeline and resource needs	AGL	POL	Day 7

Week 2

Focus: AI Discovery & Shadow AI Detection

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Send AI discovery survey to all Business Unit Leads	AGL	AIR §§1–3	Day 10
Reconcile AI tools against procurement and vendor contract list	Procurement / AGL	AIR §9	Day 12
Reconcile AI tools against SSO / IdP app catalog	IT	AIR §9	Day 12
Reconcile AI tools against cloud / API inventory	IT	AIR §4	Day 14
Flag shadow AI tools discovered outside approved channels	IT / AGL	AIR §9	Day 14
Populate AI Inventory: identity, business context, technical fields	AGL + BULs	AIR §§2–4	Day 14

Week 3

Focus: Risk Tiering & Data/Privacy Fields

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Complete data and privacy fields for all discovered AI entries	Privacy / Legal	AIR §5, PRI	Day 17

Assign initial risk tier to every AI entry (Low/Moderate/High/Critical)	AGL + BULs	AIR §6	Day 19
Flag any AI systems requiring DPIA / privacy impact assessment	Privacy	PRI	Day 21
Complete risk and compliance fields for all AI registry entries	AGL / GRC	AIR §6	Day 21
Document applicable regulations per AI entry (CCPA, HIPAA, etc.)	Legal	REG	Day 21
Identify top 5 highest-risk AI use cases for priority assessment	AGL	AIR §6	Day 21

Week 4**Focus: AI Intake Process & Policy Kickoff**

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Publish AI Inventory v1.0 to shared program repository	AGL	AIR §§7–10	Day 25
Design and launch AI Use Case Intake / Triage process	AGL / IT	AIR §1	Day 25
Define registry update cadence (monthly) and assign registry owner	AGL	AIR §§1, 8	Day 25
Begin drafting AI Acceptable Use Policy	AGL / Legal	POL	Day 28
Begin drafting AI Risk Management Policy	AGL / GRC	POL	Day 28
Begin vendor identification list for AI Third-Party Due Diligence	Procurement	VDD §1	Day 30
Phase 1 review and executive briefing	AGL / Exec Sponsor	—	Day 30

Phase 1 Milestones & Success Criteria

Day	Milestone	Evidence / Output	Owner
Day 5	AI Governance Working Group formed	Meeting minutes, member list	Exec Sponsor
Day 7	Program charter approved	Signed charter document	AGL
Day 14	AI Inventory v0.1 populated	Registry spreadsheet / GRC entry	AGL
Day 21	All AI entries risk-tiered	Updated registry with risk tiers	AGL + BULs
Day 25	AI Inventory v1.0 published	Accessible registry in shared repo	AGL
Day 28	Policy drafts initiated	Working drafts in review pipeline	AGL / Legal
Day 30	Phase 1 executive briefing complete	Briefing deck + action items log	Exec Sponsor

PHASE 2

Build & Assess

Days 31 – 60

Phase 2 is where governance goes deep. You will complete risk assessments for priority AI systems, run security and privacy reviews, conduct vendor due diligence, finalize and approve foundational policies, and begin standing up human oversight and monitoring frameworks. This phase converts your inventory into an assessed, documented, and controlled AI portfolio.

Phase 2 Objectives

- Complete risk assessments for all High/Critical AI use cases; triage Moderate cases.
- Finalize and gain executive approval for the AI Acceptable Use Policy and AI Risk Management Policy.
- Complete vendor due diligence assessments for all active AI-enabled vendors.
- Conduct security reviews for all production AI systems.
- Complete privacy screening and flag DPIA candidates.
- Design human oversight controls and escalation paths for high-risk AI decisions.
- Stand up the AI Model Validation framework for any internally developed or fine-tuned models.

Week 5

Focus: Risk Assessments – High & Critical AI Use Cases

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Conduct full risk assessment for each High/Critical AI use case	AGL / GRC	AIR §6	Day 35
Document risk findings, controls, and residual risk per use case	AGL / GRC	AIR §6	Day 35
Link risk assessment records to AI registry entries	AGL	AIR §7	Day 35
Flag unacceptable residual risks for executive decision / suspension	AGL	POL	Day 35
Begin security review for production AI systems	IT / Security	SEC	Day 37
Identify and document applicable compliance obligations per AI use case	Legal / GRC	REG	Day 37

Week 6

Focus: Security Reviews & Vendor Due Diligence

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Complete AI Security Review for all production AI systems	IT / Security	SEC	Day 42
Document access controls, MFA/SSO coverage, API scopes per system	IT	SEC	Day 42
Identify and document logging / audit trail gaps	IT / Security	SEC	Day 42
Send AI Third-Party Due Diligence Questionnaire to all AI vendors	Procurement / AGL	VDD §§1–3	Day 44
Review vendor DPA / data processing agreements for AI-specific terms	Legal	VDD §3	Day 44
Document vendor training/retention terms and cross-border data transfers	Privacy / Legal	VDD §3	Day 44

Week 7**Focus: Privacy Screening, Policy Finalization & DPIA**

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Complete Privacy & DPIA Screening for all flagged AI use cases	Privacy	PRI	Day 49
Initiate DPIAs for use cases that meet DPIA threshold criteria	Privacy / Legal	PRI	Day 49
Finalize AI Acceptable Use Policy – legal and exec review cycle	AGL / Legal / Exec	POL	Day 49
Finalize AI Risk Management Policy – legal and exec review cycle	AGL / GRC / Legal	POL	Day 49
Draft AI Data Handling & Privacy Policy	Privacy / Legal	POL	Day 49
Review and finalize Vendor Due Diligence responses from vendors	Procurement / AGL	VDD §§4–7	Day 51

Week 8**Focus: Human Oversight, Model Validation & Policy Approval**

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Define reviewer roles and decision boundaries for all High/Critical AI	AGL / BULs	HOE	Day 55
Document escalation paths, override rules, and fallback procedures	AGL / BULs	HOE	Day 55
Confirm human oversight controls are operational for production AI	IT / BULs	HOE	Day 55
Complete Model Validation / Testing Checklist for internally developed models	IT / Data Team	MVT	Day 57
Gain executive approval: Acceptable Use Policy	Exec Sponsor	POL	Day 58
Gain executive approval: Risk Management Policy	Exec Sponsor	POL	Day 58
Publish approved policies to internal policy repository	AGL	POL	Day 60
Phase 2 review and executive briefing	AGL / Exec Sponsor	—	Day 60

Phase 2 Milestones & Success Criteria

Day	Milestone	Evidence / Output	Owner
Day 35	Risk assessments complete (High/Critical)	Assessment docs linked in registry	AGL / GRC
Day 42	Security reviews complete – all production	Security review log per system	IT / Security
Day 44	VDD questionnaires sent to all AI vendors	Questionnaire distribution log	Procurement
Day 49	Privacy screening complete; DPIAs initiated	PRI screening log; DPIA intake list	Privacy
Day 55	Human oversight controls documented	HOE checklist complete per use case	AGL / BULs
Day 58	Two core policies approved by Exec	Signed / version-controlled policy docs	Exec Sponsor
Day 60	Phase 2 executive briefing complete	Briefing deck + policy publication	Exec Sponsor

PHASE 3

Operationalize & Sustain

Days 61 – 90

Phase 3 converts your governance program from a project into a repeatable operational discipline. You will complete staff training, stand up monitoring and revalidation processes, finalize and test the AI incident response playbook, complete change management procedures, and deliver a 90-Day Program Completion Report to your executive leadership. Governance must run after Day 90—this phase ensures it does.

Phase 3 Objectives

- Complete role-based AI governance training for all staff categories.
- Stand up the AI Monitoring & Revalidation process with assigned owners and schedules.
- Finalize and tabletop-test the AI Incident Response Playbook.
- Document and activate Change Management procedures for AI system updates.
- Complete regulatory change mapping for applicable AI laws and frameworks.
- Deliver the 90-Day AI Governance Completion Report to leadership.
- Establish the ongoing governance calendar (quarterly reviews, annual policy refresh).

Week 9

Focus: AI Training Program Rollout

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Deploy role-based AI governance training for Business Users	AGL / HR	TRN	Day 65
Deploy AI governance training for IT / Developers / Data Teams	AGL / IT	TRN	Day 65
Brief Executive Team on AI governance program status and obligations	AGL	TRN	Day 65
Track training completion rates per role category	AGL / HR	TRN	Day 67
Draft AI Incident Response Playbook (AI-specific IR procedures)	Security / AGL	IRP	Day 67
Identify AI incident categories and response owners	Security / AGL	IRP	Day 67

Week 10

Focus: Monitoring Framework & Change Management

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Assign monitoring owners for every Active AI use case	AGL	MON §§1–3	Day 72
Define KPIs and KRIs for each monitored AI system	AGL / BULS	MON §4	Day 72
Set up monitoring schedules (continuous / quarterly / semi-annual by tier)	AGL / IT	MON §§10–12	Day 72
Configure logging and alerting for High/Critical AI systems	IT / Security	MON §5	Day 72
Finalize AI Change Management Checklist and process	AGL / IT	CMC	Day 74
Document what constitutes a 'material change' requiring re-review	AGL / Legal	CMC	Day 74

Week 11

Focus: Incident Response Testing & Regulatory Mapping

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Tabletop test AI Incident Response Playbook (hallucination scenario)	Security / AGL / BUL	IRP	Day 79
Tabletop test AI IR Playbook (data leakage scenario)	Security / Privacy	IRP	Day 79
Document IR test findings and update playbook accordingly	Security / AGL	IRP	Day 79
Complete Regulatory Change Impact Assessment for current AI regulations	Legal / GRC	REG	Day 81
Map applicable regulations to specific AI use cases and required controls	Legal / AGL	REG	Day 81
Confirm training completion at or above 90% target for all roles	AGL / HR	TRN	Day 81

Week 12**Focus: Program Completion & Governance Calendar**

Activity	Owner	Checklist Ref	Due (Day)
Complete evidence pack for all High/Critical AI use cases	AGL	AIR §7	Day 85
Conduct final registry quality check – all fields complete and current	AGL	AIR §10	Day 85
Establish ongoing AI governance calendar (quarterly reviews, annual refresh)	AGL	MON	Day 87
Draft 90-Day AI Governance Completion Report	AGL	—	Day 87
Present 90-Day Completion Report to Executive Leadership	AGL / Exec Sponsor	—	Day 90
Transition program to steady-state operational ownership	AGL	—	Day 90
Schedule Day 180 program maturity review	AGL / Exec Sponsor	—	Day 90

Phase 3 Milestones & Success Criteria

Day	Milestone	Evidence / Output	Owner
Day 65	Role-based training deployed to all staff	Training completion tracker	AGL / HR
Day 72	Monitoring owners and schedules assigned	MON checklist per active use case	AGL
Day 74	Change Management process finalized	CMC documented and published	AGL / IT
Day 79	IR Playbook tabletop test complete	Test report + updated playbook	Security
Day 81	Regulatory mapping complete	REG impact assessment document	Legal / GRC
Day 85	Evidence packs complete – High/Critical	Evidence pack per use case	AGL
Day 90	90-Day Completion Report presented	Signed report; governance calendar	Exec Sponsor

Program Health Metrics & KPIs

Track the following metrics throughout the 90 days to measure program health and report progress to your Executive Sponsor. These metrics align directly to the Govsecure AI Governance Checklist completion criteria.

KPI	Target by Day 30	Target by Day 60	Target by Day 90
AI Inventory completeness	80% fields populated	95% fields populated	100% complete & verified
Risk tier assigned – all entries	100% tiered	100% tiered	100% current & revalidated
High/Critical risk assessments	Initiated	100% complete	100% + evidence linked
Security reviews completed	Initiated for top 3	100% production systems	100% + gaps remediated
Vendor due diligence assessments	Vendors identified	100% questionnaires sent	100% reviewed & filed
Privacy screening / DPIAs	Flagging complete	DPIAs initiated	DPIAs complete or scheduled
Policies approved (core set)	Drafts in review	2 policies approved	Full suite approved
Human oversight controls	Designed	Documented for High/Crit	Operational & tested
Staff training completion rate	Program designed	Deployed to all roles	>=90% completion
Monitoring cadence established	Planned	Owners assigned	Active & documented
AI IR Playbook	Drafted	Finalized	Tabletop tested

Quick Reference: 90-Day Governance Calendar

Week	Days	Phase	Key Outputs
Week 1	1–7	Phase 1	Working group formed, program charter, tracking system live
Week 2	8–14	Phase 1	AI discovery complete, inventory v0.1, shadow AI flagged
Week 3	15–21	Phase 1	Risk tiers assigned, privacy flags set, compliance obligations documented
Week 4	22–30	Phase 1	Inventory v1.0 published, intake process live, policy drafts started
Week 5	31–37	Phase 2	Risk assessments complete (High/Critical), security reviews initiated
Week 6	38–44	Phase 2	Security reviews complete, VDD questionnaires sent
Week 7	45–51	Phase 2	Privacy screening done, DPIAs initiated, policy final review
Week 8	52–60	Phase 2	Human oversight documented, model validation done, 2 policies approved
Week 9	61–67	Phase 3	All staff trained, IR playbook drafted
Week 10	68–74	Phase 3	Monitoring owners + schedules active, change management live
Week 11	75–81	Phase 3	IR playbook tabletop tested, regulatory mapping complete
Week 12	82–90	Phase 3	Evidence packs done, 90-Day report presented, governance calendar set

Post-90 Days: Run your first quarterly AI governance review (Month 6), annual policy refresh (Month 12), and use the Govsecure AI Monitoring & Revalidation Checklist for each scheduled revalidation cycle. Governance is not a project—it is an operating discipline.

About Govsecure

Govsecure is the AI Governance platform built for SMBs. Our checklist templates, intake forms, risk assessment frameworks, and implementation blueprints are designed to give small and mid-sized organizations enterprise-grade AI governance capabilities—without the enterprise-grade overhead. For questions, customization support, or platform access, contact your Govsecure program advisor.

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